

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Impress Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter 1 **Introducing Impress**

Copyright

This document is Copyright © 2025 by The Apache Software Foundation. You may distribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, version 3.0 or later (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Apache, Apache OpenOffice, and OpenOffice.org are trademarks of the Apache Software Foundation. Used with permission.

Acknowledgments

This book is updated from a previous version by the OOoAuthors team. The AOO Documentation Team appreciates the many contributions of Michael Scarborough and Michele Petrovsky.

Publication date and software version

Published October 30, 2025. Based on Apache OpenOffice 4.1.

Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

Windows/Linux	Mac equivalent	Effect
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	⌘+T	Open Styles & Formatting window

Contents

Chapter 1

Introducing Impress.....	1
What is Impress?.....	4
Starting Impress.....	4
The Main Impress Window.....	5
Slides Pane.....	5
Sidebar.....	6
Workspace.....	7
Toolbars.....	7
Status Bar.....	7
Navigator.....	8
Workspace Views.....	8
Normal View.....	8
Outline View.....	9
Notes View.....	9
Handout View.....	10
Slide Sorter View.....	10
Creating a New Presentation.....	12
Formatting a Presentation.....	15
Inserting Slides.....	15
Selecting a Layout.....	16
Modifying the Slide Elements.....	17
Modifying the Appearance of Slides.....	19
Modifying the Slide Show.....	20
Running the Slide Show.....	21

What is Impress?

Impress is Apache OpenOffice's slide show or presentation program. You can create slides that contain different elements, including text, bulleted and numbered lists, tables, charts, clip art, and a wide range of graphic objects. Impress also includes a spelling checker, a thesaurus, prepackaged text styles, and attractive background styles.

This chapter introduces the Impress user interface and describes how to create a simple slide show using the Presentation Wizard.

The rest of this guide illustrates many other features available in Impress that can be used to create more sophisticated slide shows.

Note	Drawings are created in the same way with Impress as they are with Draw. Refer to the <i>Draw Guide</i> for details on how to use drawing facilities.
-------------	---

Starting Impress

You can start Impress in several ways:

- If no component of AOO is open, from the Start Center, click on the Presentation icon.
- From the system menu or the Quickstarter. Details vary with your operating system; see Chapter 1 in the *Getting Started* guide for more information.
- From any open component of AOO: click the triangle to the right of the **New** icon on the main toolbar and select *Presentation* from the drop-down menu, or choose **File > New > Presentation** from the menu bar.

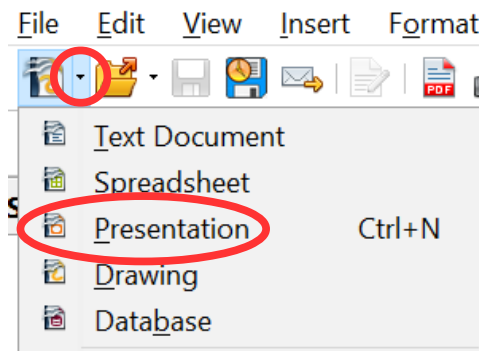


Figure 1: Opening the presentation wizard

When you start Impress for the first time, the Presentation Wizard is shown. For detailed instructions about how to use the wizard, see “Creating a New Presentation” on page 12. If you prefer not to use the wizard in the future, you can select **Do not show this wizard again**.

Click **Create** to open the main Impress window.

The Main Impress Window

The main Impress window (Figure 2) has three parts: the *Slides pane*, the *Workspace*, and the *Sidebar*. Additionally, several toolbars can be displayed or hidden during the creation of a presentation.

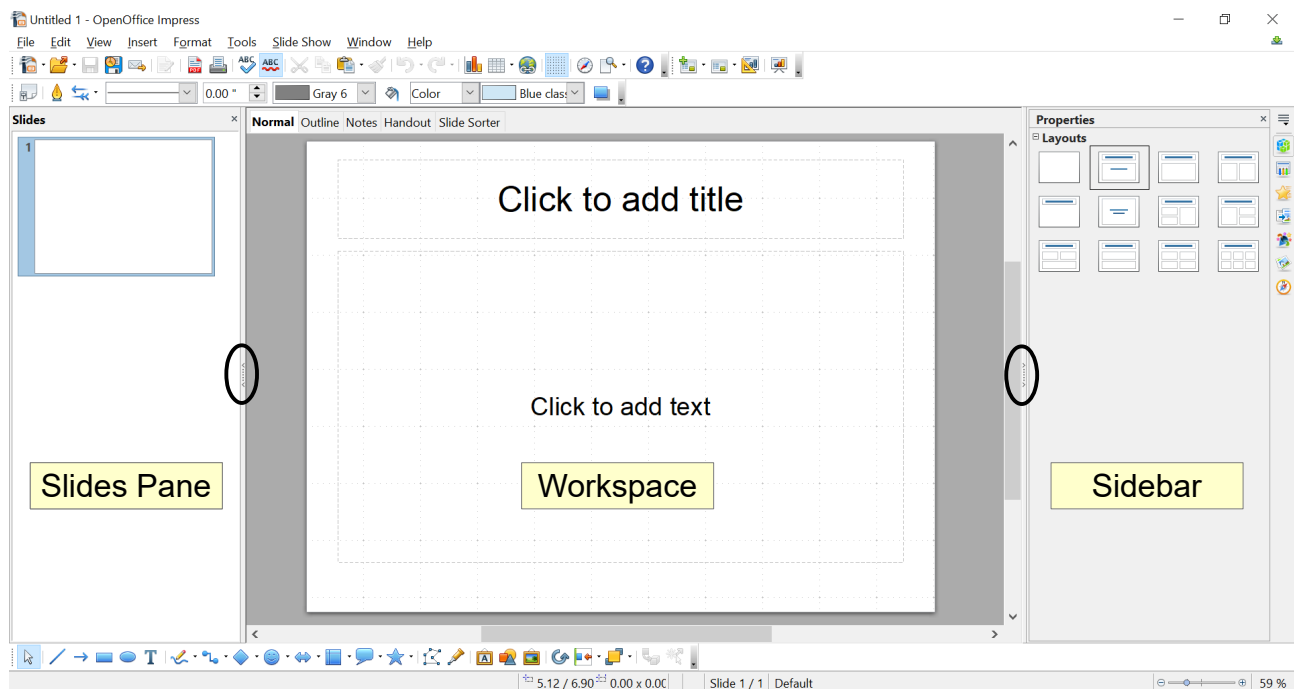


Figure 2: Main window of Impress

Tip

You can remove the Slides pane or the Sidebar from view by clicking the X in the upper-right corner of each pane. You can also show or hide these panes using **View > Slide Pane** or **View > Sidebar** or by clicking the Hide/Show markers that have been circled in the middle of the vertical separator lines. Hiding these panes allows you to maximize the *Workspace* area.

Slides Pane

The Slides pane contains thumbnail pictures of the slides in your presentation, in the order they will be shown—unless you change the slide show order, as described in Chapter 9 (Slide Shows). Clicking a slide in this pane selects it and places it in the Workspace. When a slide is in the Workspace, you can change it in any way you like.

Several other operations can be performed simultaneously on one or more slides in the Slides pane:

- Add new slides to the presentation.
- Mark a slide as hidden so that it will not be shown as part of the presentation.
- Delete a slide from the presentation if it is no longer needed.
- Rename a slide.
- Duplicate a slide (copy and paste) or move it to a different position in the presentation (cut and paste).

While there are more efficient ways of carrying out the operations immediately below, it's possible to do them using the Slides pane.

- Change the slide transition following the selected slide or after each slide in a group of slides.
- Change the sequence of slides in the presentation.
- Change the slide design.
- Change the slide layout for a group of slides simultaneously.

Sidebar

The Sidebar has seven decks: To select the deck you wish to use, click on its icon on the right edge of the Sidebar.

Properties

This deck adapts to what is selected in the Workspace. In Figure 2, nothing is selected in the slide, so the deck shows a single panel of slide layouts. Clicking on a layout icon in the Sidebar applies that layout to the current slide. If you click on the text *Click to add text* in the slide, a text cursor appears on the slide, and the Properties deck changes to have two panels, one for text properties and one for paragraph properties. If a shape, picture, or table were on the slide and selected, panels appropriate for setting the properties of the selected object would appear.

Master Pages

On this deck, you define the page style for your presentation. It has three panels: *Used in This Presentation*, *Recently Used*, and *Available for Use*. Impress contains prepackaged Master Pages (slide masters). One of them—Default—is blank, and the rest have a background and styled text.

Custom Animation

A variety of animations for selected elements of a slide are listed. Animation can be added to a slide and later changed or removed. See Chapter 9 (Slide Shows) for an overview of how to add and customize animations.

Slide Transition

Many transitions are available, including *No Transition*, which makes the next slide simply replace the existing one. You can select the transition speed (slow, medium, fast). You can also choose between an automatic or manual transition, and how long the selected slide should be shown (automatic transition only).

Styles and Formatting

The Styles and Formatting deck is identical to the tool opened by the menu **Format > Styles and Formatting**. Impress documents have *Graphics Styles* and *Presentation Styles*. Graphics Styles are generally applied to drawn objects, setting properties like their fill color and line type, and images and Presentation Styles are applied to text, such as bullet points and title.

Gallery

The Gallery deck provides access to a variety of images, clip art, and sounds. These are stored in themes. You can add your own items and themes. The menu **Tools > Gallery** opens the same tool but places it by default above the Workspace, inconveniently shrinking the Workspace.

Navigator

The Navigator deck is identical to the tool opened by the menu **View > Navigator** or pressing *Ctrl + Shift + F5*. This allows you to move easily among the slides and

select content such as shapes and objects. It is much easier to select objects if you give them meaningful names rather than using the default names like Shape1.

Workspace

The Workspace (normally in the center) has five tabs, also called *View buttons*.

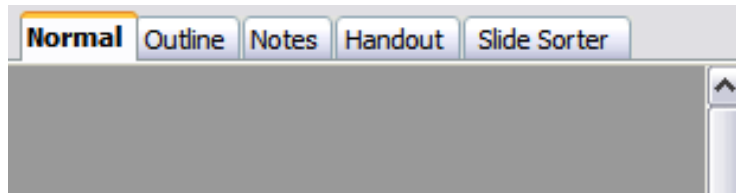


Figure 3: Workspace tabs

The Workspace below the View buttons changes depending on the chosen view. The workspace views are described in detail on page 8.

Toolbars

Many toolbars can be used during slide creation; they can be displayed or hidden by clicking **View > Toolbars** and selecting from the menu.

You can also select the icons that you wish to use for each toolbar. For more information, refer to Chapter 11 (Setting Up and Customizing Impress).

Many of the toolbars in Impress are similar to the toolbars in Draw. Refer to the *Draw Guide* for details on the functions available and how to use them.

Status Bar

The status bar, located at the bottom of the Impress window, contains information that you may find useful when working on a presentation.

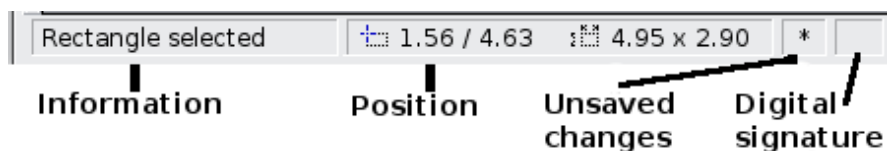


Figure 4: Left end of the Impress status bar

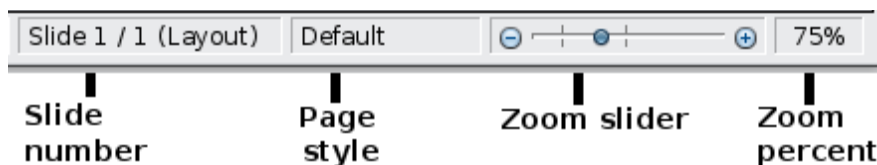


Figure 5: Right end of Impress status bar

From left to right, you will find:

- A general information area, which changes depending on the selection. For example:

Selected Item	Information Displayed on the Status Bar
Text area	TextEdit: Paragraph x, Row y, Column z
Embedded Spreadsheet	Embedded object (OLE) 'ObjectName' selected
Graphics	Bitmap with transparency selected

- The position of the cursor or of the top left corner of the selection measured from the top left corner of the slide, followed by the width and height of the selection or of the text box where the cursor is located.
- A modified flag, showing a star when the file needs saving.
- A flag indicating whether the document is digitally signed.
- The slide number currently displayed in the workspace, and the total number of slides in the presentation.
- The slide master or page style associated with the slide, handout, or notes page currently in the Workspace.
- The zoom slider and zoom level (percent) of the Workspace.

Note

The sizes are given in the current measurement unit (not to be confused with the ruler units). This unit is defined in **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Impress > General**

You can hide the information in the Status Bar by selecting **View > Status Bar** from the main menu.

Navigator

The Navigator displays all objects contained in a document. It provides another convenient way to move around a document and find items in it. To display the Navigator, click its icon on the Standard toolbar, or choose **View > Navigator** on the menu bar, or press *Ctrl+Shift+F5*.

The Navigator is more useful if you give your slides and objects (pictures, spreadsheets, and so on) meaningful names, instead of leaving them as the default "Object 1" and "Shape 1" shown in the example.

Workspace Views

Each of the workspace views is designed to facilitate the completion of certain tasks. Familiarizing yourself with these views will help you accomplish tasks more quickly.

Normal View

Normal view is the main view for creating individual slides. Use this view to format and design slides and to add text, graphics, and animation effects.

To place a slide in the slide design area (Workspace) of the Normal view (Figure 2), either click the slide thumbnail in the Slides pane or double-click it in the Navigator (page 8).

Outline View

Outline view contains all of the slides of the presentation in their numbered sequence. It shows topic titles, bulleted lists, and numbered lists for each slide in outline format. Only the text contained in the default text boxes in each slide is shown, so if your slide includes other text boxes or drawing objects, the text in these objects is not displayed. Slide names are not included.

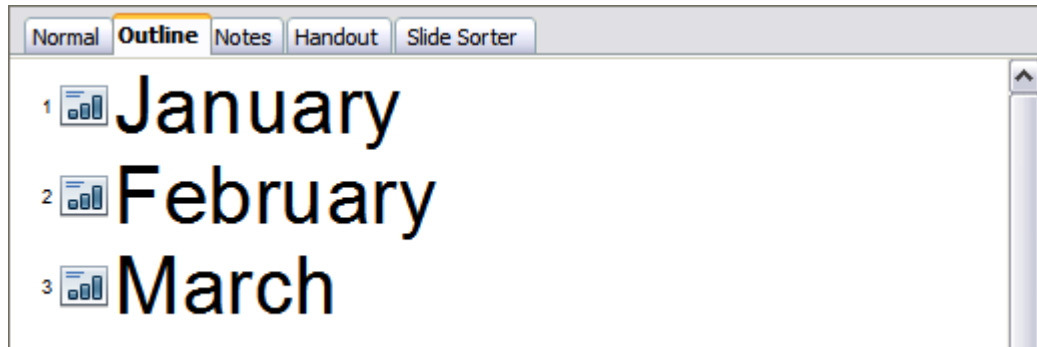


Figure 6: Outline view

Use Outline view for:

- 1) Making changes in the text of a slide:
 - Add or delete text in a slide, just as in the Normal view.
 - Move the paragraphs of text in the selected slide up or down by using the up and down arrow buttons (Move Up or Move Down) on the Text Formatting toolbar.
 - Change the outline level for any of the paragraphs in a slide using the left and right arrow buttons (Promote or Demote).
 - Simultaneously move a paragraph and change its outline level using a combination of these four arrow buttons.
- 2) Compare the slides with your outline (if you have prepared one in advance). If you notice from your outline that another slide is needed, you can create it directly in the Outline view, or you can return to the Normal view to create it.



Notes View

Use the Notes view (Figure 7) to add notes to a slide. These notes are not seen when the presentation is shown.

- 1) Click the **Notes** tab in the Workspace.
- 2) Select the slide to which you want to add notes.
 - Click the slide in the Slide pane, or
 - Double-click the slide's name in the Navigator.
- 3) In the text box below the slide, click on the words *Click to add notes* and begin typing.

You can resize the Notes text box using the green resizing handles and move it by placing the pointer on the border, then clicking and dragging. To make changes in the text style, use the Styles and Formatting deck of the Sidebar or press the *F11* key to open the Styles and Formatting window and modify the Notes style among the Presentation styles.

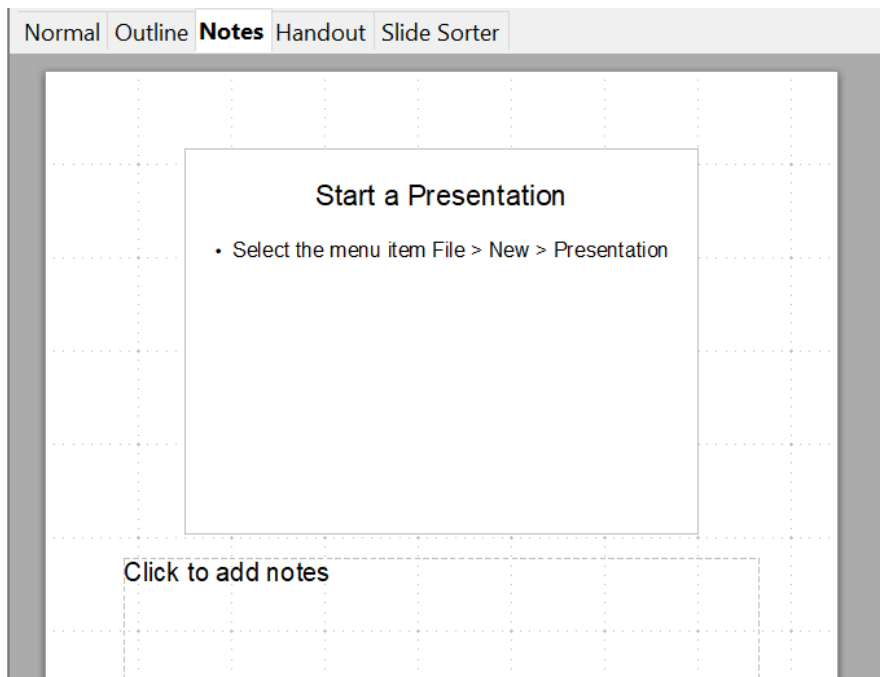


Figure 7: Adding notes in Notes view

Handout View

Handout view is for setting up the layout for a printed handout. Click the *Handout* tab in the workspace, then choose the Properties deck of the Sidebar. You can then choose to print 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 9 slides per page.

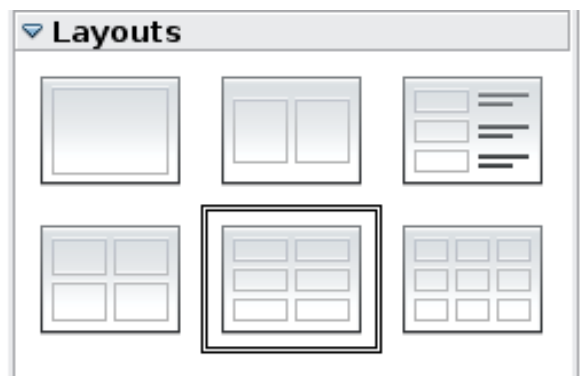


Figure 8: Handout layouts

Use this view also to customize the information printed on the handout. Refer to Chapter 10 of this book for instructions on printing slides, handouts, and notes.

Slide Sorter View

The Slide Sorter view contains all of the slide thumbnails. Use this view to work with a group of slides or with only one slide.

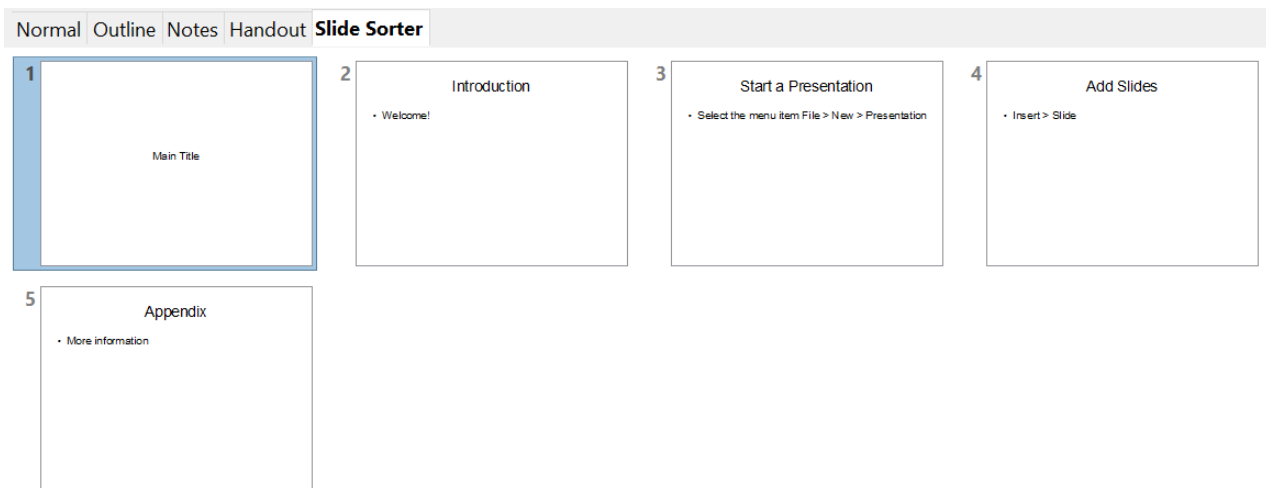


Figure 9: Slide Sorter view

Customizing Slide Sorter View

To change the number of slides per row:

- 1) Check **View > Toolbars > Slide View** to show or hide the Slide view toolbar.



Figure 10: Slide Sorter and Slide View toolbars

- 2) Adjust the number of slides (up to a maximum of 15).

Moving a Slide Using Slide Sorter

To move a slide in a presentation using the Slide Sorter:

- 1) Click the slide. A thick border is drawn around it.
- 2) Drag and drop it to the location you want. As you move the slide, a black vertical line appears to one side of the slide. Drag the slide until this black vertical line is located where you want the slide to be.

Selecting and Moving Groups of Slides

To select a group of slides, use one of these methods:

- Use the *Control (Ctrl)* key: Click on the first slide and, while pressing *Control*, select the other desired slides.
- Use the *Shift* key: Click on the first slide, and while pressing the *Shift* key, select the final slide in the group. This selects all of the other slides between the first and the last.
- Use the mouse: Click slightly to the left of the first slide to be selected. Hold down the left mouse button, and drag the mouse pointer to a spot slightly to the right of the last slide to be included. (You can also do this right to left.) A dashed outline of a rectangle forms as you drag the pointer through the slide thumbnails, and a thick border is drawn around the selected slides. Make sure the rectangle includes all the slides you want to select.

To move a group of slides:

- 1) Select the group.

- 2) Drag and drop the group to its new location. A vertical black line appears to show you where the group of slides will go.

Working in Slide Sorter View

You can work with slides in the Slide Sorter view just as you can in the Slide pane.

To make changes, right-click a slide and choose any of the following from the pop-up menu:

- Add a new slide after the selected slide.
- Rename or delete the selected slide.
- Change the slide layout using the Sidebar.
- Change the slide transition of one or more slides using the Sidebar.
- Mark a slide as hidden. Hidden slides will not be shown in the slide show.
- Copy or cut and paste a slide.

Renaming Slides

Right-click on a thumbnail in the Slides pane or the Slide Sorter and choose **Rename Slide** from the pop-up menu. In the *Name* field, delete the old name of the slide and type the new name. Click **OK**.

Creating a New Presentation

This section shows you how to set up a new presentation using the Presentation Wizard.

Tip

First decide on the purpose of the presentation. Then, plan the presentation. Although you can make changes as you go, having an idea of who the audience will be, the structure and content of the presentation, and how the presentation will be delivered, will save you time and effort from the start.

When you start Impress, the Presentation Wizard appears.

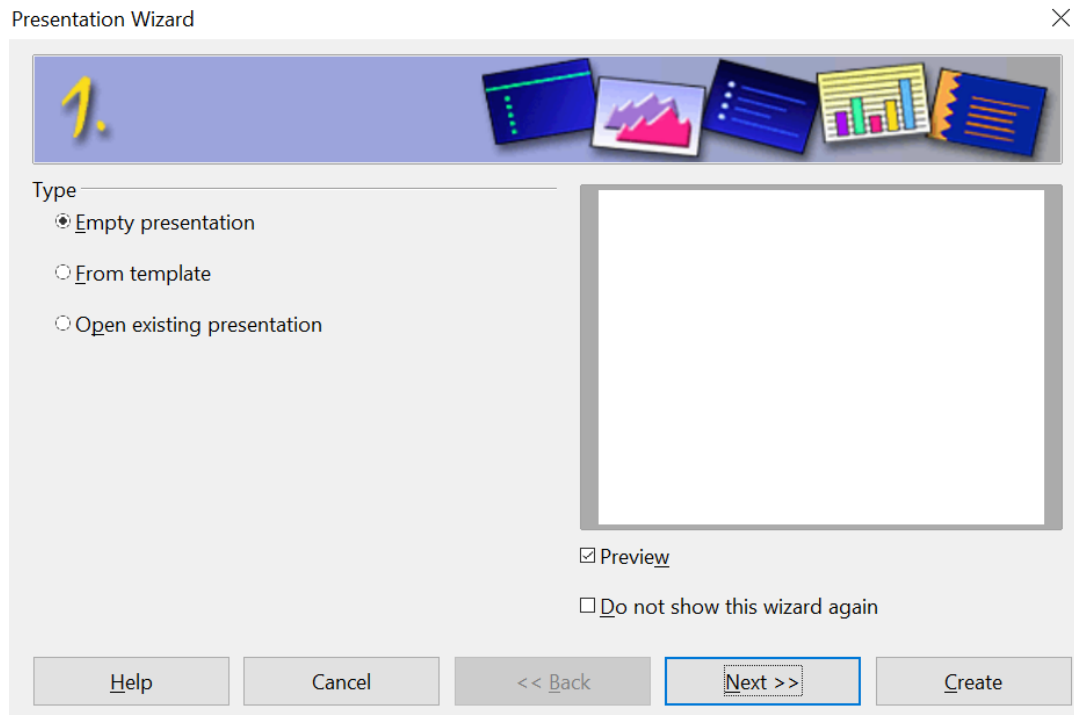


Figure 11. Choosing the type of presentation

Tip

If you do not want the wizard to start every time you start Impress, select the **Do not show this wizard again** option. You can enable the wizard again later by going to **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Impress > General** and selecting the **Start with wizard** option.

Leave the **Preview** option selected, so templates, slide designs, and slide transitions appear in the preview box as you choose them.

- 1) Under **Type**, choose one of the options:
 - *Empty presentation* creates a blank presentation.
 - *From template* uses a template design already created as the basis for a new presentation. The wizard changes to show a list of available templates. Choose the template you want. More details can be found in Chapter 2.
 - *Open existing presentation* continues work on a previously created presentation. The wizard changes to show a list of existing presentations. Choose the one you want.
- 2) Click **Next**. Figure 12 shows the **Presentation Wizard** step 2 as it appears if you selected *Empty presentation* at step 1. If you selected *From template*, an example slide is shown in the Preview box.
- 3) Choose a design under **Select a slide design**. The slide design section gives you two main choices: *Presentation Backgrounds* and *Presentations*. Each one has a list of choices for slide designs. If you want to use one of these other than *<Original>*, click it to select it.

The types of *Presentation Backgrounds* are shown in Figure 12. When you click an item, a preview of the slide design appears in the Preview window. *<Original>* is an empty background.

Impress contains three choices under *Presentations*:

- *<Original>* is for a blank presentation slide design.
- Both *Introducing a New Product* and *Recommendation of a Strategy* have their own prepackaged slide designs. Each design appears in the Preview window when its name is clicked.

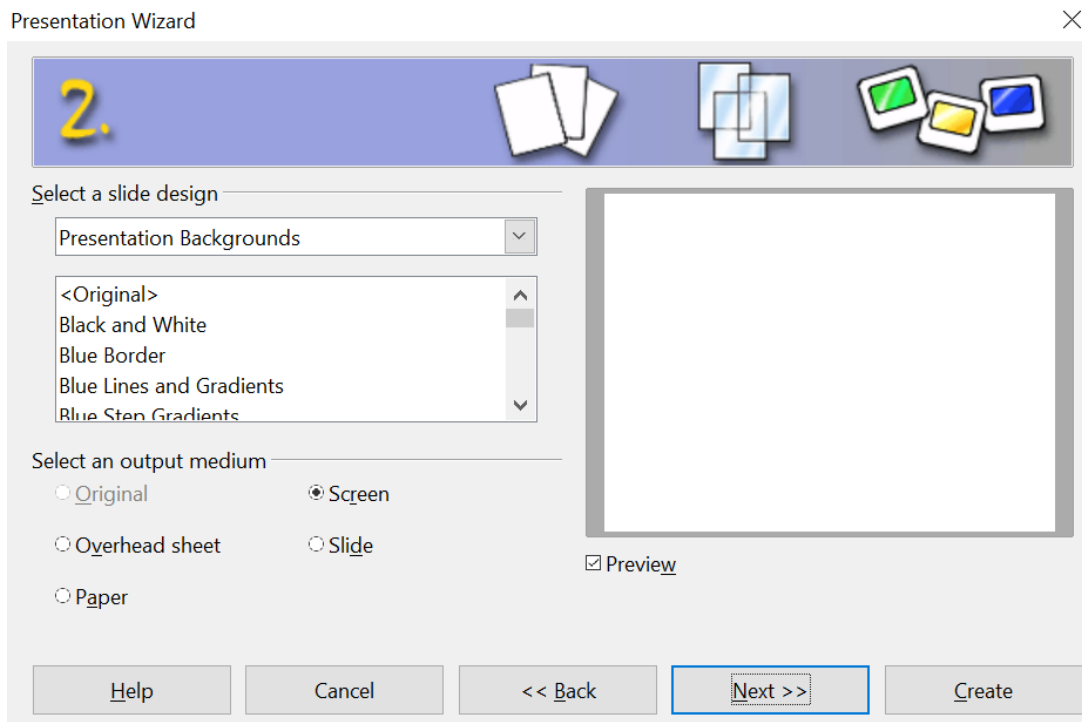


Figure 12. Selecting a slide design

To start with a blank presentation, select *<Original>*. Click an item to see a preview of the slide design in the Preview window.

Note

Introducing a New Product and *Recommendation of a Strategy* are prepackaged presentation templates. They can be used to create a presentation by choosing **From template** in the first step (Figure 11).

-
- 4) Select how the presentation will be used under **Select an output medium**. Most often, presentations are created for display on a computer monitor, so you would select **Screen**. You can change the page format at any time.

Note

The default Screen page is optimized for a 4:3 display (28cm x 21cm), so it is not suitable for modern widescreen displays. You can change the slide size at any time, switching to Normal view and selecting **Format > Page**.

-
- 5) Click **Next**. The Presentation Wizard step 3 appears. Choose the desired slide transition from the *Effect* drop-down menu. Select the desired speed for the transition between the different slides in the presentation from the *Speed* drop-down menu. **Medium** is a good choice for now.

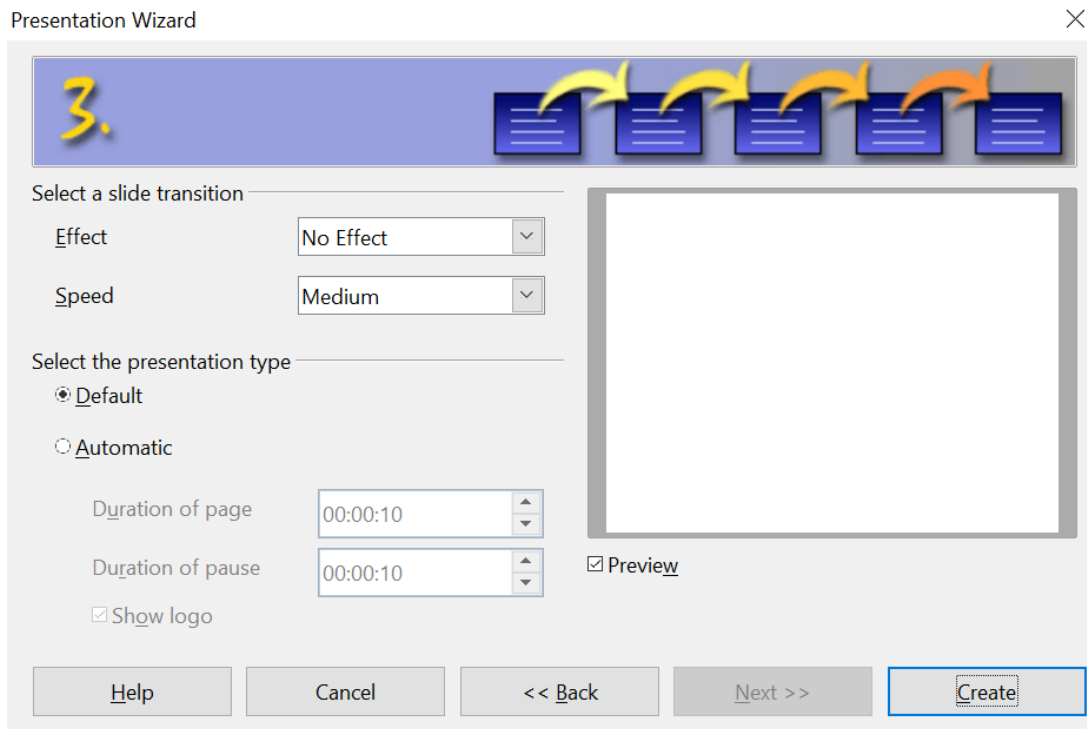


Figure 13: Selecting a slide transition effect

6) Click **Create**. A new presentation is created.

Tip

Unless you are skilled at creating presentations, you might want to accept the default values for both Effect and Speed. Both of these values can be changed later while working with slide transitions and animations. These two are explained in more detail in Chapter 9 (Slide Shows).

Note

If you selected *From template* on step 1 of the Wizard, the **Next** button will be active on step 3, and other pages will be available. These pages are not described here.

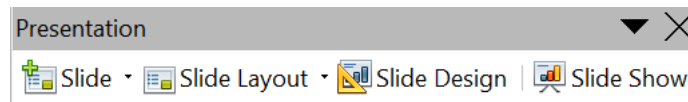
Formatting a Presentation

A new presentation only contains one empty slide. In this section, we will start adding new slides and preparing them for the intended contents.

Inserting Slides

This can be done in a variety of ways; take your pick.

- **Insert > Slide.**
- Right-click on the present slide, and select **Slide > New Slide** from the pop-up menu.
- Click the **Slide** icon in the *Presentation* toolbar.



Sometimes, rather than starting from a new slide, you want to duplicate a slide you have already inserted. To do so, select the slide you want to duplicate from the Slides pane and then choose **Insert > Duplicate Slide**.

Selecting a Layout

In the Sidebar, make sure nothing is selected in the current slide. Then select the Properties deck to display the available layouts. The Layouts differ in the number of elements a slide will contain, from a blank slide to a slide with six content boxes and a title.

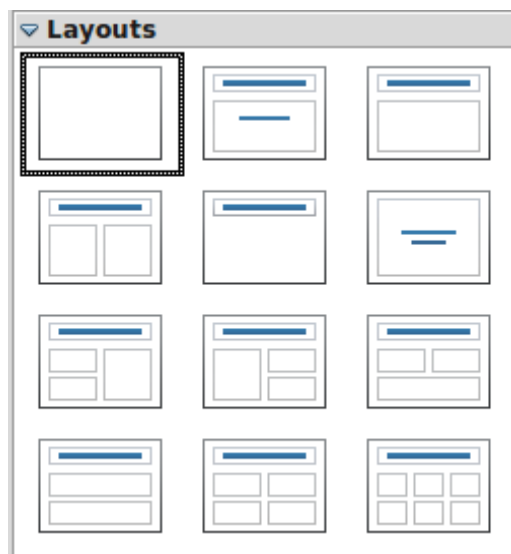


Figure 14: Choosing a slide layout

The first slide in a presentation is normally a title slide. The *Title Slide* (which also contains a section for a subtitle) or *Title Only* are suitable layouts for the first slide, while for most of the slides, you will probably use the *Title, Contents* layout.

To create the title, click on *Click to add title* (assuming the *Blank Slide* layout was not used) and then type the title text. To adjust the formatting of the title, modify the *Title* presentation style; see Chapter 2 (Using Slide Masters, Styles, and Templates) for instructions.

If you are using the *Title Slide* layout, click on *Click to add text* to add a subtitle. Proceed as above to make adjustments to the formatting if required, modifying the *Subtitle* presentation style instead.

Tip

To view the names of prepackaged layouts, use the Tooltip feature: position the cursor on an icon in the Layout section (or on any toolbar icon) and its name will be displayed in a small rectangle.

If tooltips are not enabled, choose **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > General > Help** and select the Tips option. If the Extended tips option is also selected, you will get more detailed tooltip information, but the layout names themselves will not be provided.

To select or change the layout, place the slide in the work area and select the desired layout from the *Properties* deck of the Sidebar. Remember that the Sidebar content depends on what is selected. It will show the available layouts if no objects on the slide are selected

Several layouts contain one or more content boxes. Each of these boxes can be configured to contain one of the following elements: Text, Media clip, Picture, Chart, or Table.

You can choose the type of content by clicking on the icon that is displayed in the middle of the contents box, as shown in Figure 15. If instead you intend to use the contents box for text, just click anywhere on the box to get a cursor.

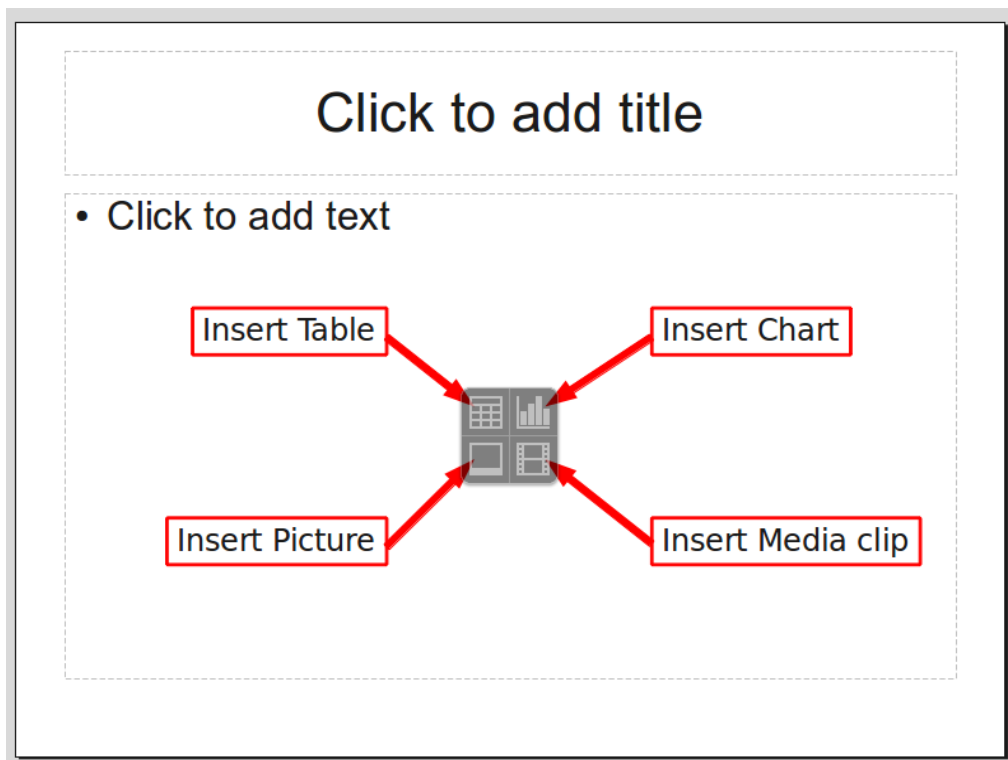


Figure 15: Selecting the desired contents type for a contents box

Note

Text and graphic elements can be readjusted at any time during the preparation of the presentation, but changing the layout of a slide that already contains some content can have a dramatic effect. It is therefore recommended that you pay particular attention to the layout you select. If you do need to change the layout after contents have been added, the contents are not lost, though they may need to be reformatted.

Modifying the Slide Elements

At this stage, the slide consists of everything contained in the slide master, as well as in the chosen layout slide. You may want to remove unneeded elements and add objects (such as pictures), as well as insert text. Most content can be inserted using a content box, as shown in Figure 15, or directly on the slide. Both methods are described in the following sections.

Caution



Changes to any of the prepackaged layouts should only be made using **View > Normal**. Attempting to make changes by modifying the slide master itself may result in erratic results and requires extra care as well as a certain amount of trial and error.

Inserting Text

Clicking on *Click to add text* in the content box starts the process of making a bulleted outline. Type the text you want for the first bullet and press *Enter* to start a new bulleted paragraph. You can use the *Tab* key to move the text to a lower outline level and *Shift + Tab* to move text to a higher outline level. You can also change the outline levels using the arrow icons on the *Text Formatting* toolbar. You can change the bullet character, indentation of the bullets, spacing of the text, and other formatting details by modifying the *Outline* styles among the *Presentation* styles in the Styles and Formatting deck of the Sidebar. It is not a good idea to set the formatting manually because that will have to be repeated on every slide, and if you change your mind about any detail, every slide with bullet points will have to be edited.

Text can also be entered inside a text box graphic. This is started by clicking the text box icon, an uppercase T, on the Drawing toolbar. Click and drag the cursor, which is now a cross, on the slide approximately where you want the text to be. When you release the mouse button, the text cursor will be inside the text box. As you type the text, the height of the box will increase as necessary. Click outside the box to finish the input. You can click immediately next to the text to select the box; it will have eight handles, and use click and drag to move or resize the box. You can change the text style used in the box by modifying the Default style among the *Graphics* styles in the Styles and Formatting deck of the Sidebar, or you can apply a different style. You can also right-click on the selected box and choose from several menu items to change the box's appearance, position, and size.

Inserting a Table

Click the *Insert Table* icon of the content box to bring up a dialog for setting the number of rows and columns in the table. Clicking **OK** in that dialog inserts a table that fills the width of the content box and has a default color scheme. If there is no content box or if it has been used for another purpose, you can insert a table with **Insert > Table**. This brings up the dialog for picking the number of rows and columns, just as with the content box. After clicking **OK**, the table is inserted near the center of the slide.

After inserting the table, clicking inside it, and then selecting the *Properties* deck of the Sidebar gives you access to the *Table Design* panel, where you can change the color scheme, banding, and other table features. You can also select one or more table cells with the mouse and use the *Table* toolbar to change colors, borders, text properties, or insert or delete entire rows and columns. As with most objects, you can right-click on the table and bring up a context menu for resizing, positioning, and adjusting many of the table's properties.

Inserting a Picture

The *Insert Picture* icon of the content box opens a dialog for selecting a file. Navigate to the desired file, choose whether to insert a link or the actual picture file at the lower left of the dialog, and click **Open**. The picture will be sized to fill either the height or the width of the content box while keeping the original height/width ratio. Alternatively, you can insert a picture with **Insert > Picture > From File**. The same

dialog will open, and you can choose the file, whether to link it, and click **Open**. The picture will be inserted near the center of the slide.

Once the picture is inserted, you can select it and resize it with the handles. It is usually best to hold the *Shift* key while resizing a picture manually so that it keeps a constant height/width ratio and does not become distorted. You can also right-click on the image and adjust its position, size, and other properties through dialogs, including an option to crop the image.

Caution



When resizing a graphic, right-click the picture. Select **Position and Size** from the context menu, and make sure that **Keep ratio** is selected. Then adjust the height or width to the size you need. Failure to do so will cause the picture to become distorted. Also, be aware that as you adjust one dimension, both dimensions will change.

Remember also that resizing a bitmap (.bmp) image will reduce its quality on screen, even though the original image is unchanged, since Impress stores the original file. A better approach is to create an image of the desired size outside of Impress, and then import it into the presentation.

Inserting a Chart

Clicking the *Insert Chart* icon in the content box or using **Insert > Chart** inserts a default column chart. The chart should be inserted as the selected object on the slide, but you can double-click near its edge to select it if needed. The first task is to enter the data for the chart and set its type (bar chart, scatter chart, etc.). Right-click on the selected chart and choose *Chart Data Table*. This brings up a dialog with a data table and icons for adding or deleting columns and rows. This dialog is appropriate for only very simple data. After entering the data, you can right-click on the chart again, pick the *Chart Type*, and set other chart properties. Using Calc to make the chart is almost certainly a better choice. It can then be copied and pasted into your presentation.

Inserting a Movie

Apache OpenOffice (AOO) Impress supports media formats, including AVI, MOV, MPG, and WAV, among others. However, its capabilities may vary depending on the specific version, operating system, and codecs installed on your computer. To ensure compatibility, it's recommended to convert media files to common formats like .avi or .mpg before inserting them into your presentation.

To remove any element on the slide that is not required, click the element to select it. The green handles show that it is selected; press the *Delete* key to remove it.

Modifying the Appearance of Slides

To change the background and other characteristics of all slides in the presentation, you need to modify the slide master or choose a different slide master.

A *Slide Master* is a slide with a specified set of characteristics that acts as a template and is used as the starting point for creating other slides. These characteristics include the background, objects in the background, formatting of any text used, and any background graphics.

Note

AOO uses three interchangeable terms for this one concept. *Master slide*, *slide master*, and *master page* all refer to a slide that is used to create other slides. This book, however, uses only the term *slide master*, except when describing the user interface.

Impress has a range of prepackaged slide masters, found in the Master Pages deck of the Sidebar. You can also create and save additional slide masters or add more from other sources. See Chapter 2 for information on creating and modifying slide masters.

If all you need to do is change the background, you can take a shortcut:

- 1) Select **Format > Page** and go to the *Background* tab.
- 2) Select the desired background between solid color, gradient, hatching, and bitmap. Click **OK** to apply it.

A dialog box opens, asking if the background should be applied to all the slides. If you click **Yes**, Impress automatically modifies the slide master for you.

Modifying the Slide Show

By default, the slide show will display all the slides in the same order as they appear in the slide sorter, without any transition between slides. Also, this default display requires some keyboard or mouse interaction to move from one slide to the next.

Now is a good time to review the entire presentation and answer some questions. Run the slide show at least once (see “Running the Slide Show” on page 21) before answering them. You might want to add some questions of your own.

- 1) Are the slides in the correct order? If not, some of them will need to be moved.
- 2) Is the information well-spaced and visible to members of an audience at the back of a large room? They may not be able to see information at the bottom of a slide, so you may need to design your presentation to fit the top three-quarters of the screen.
- 3) Would an additional slide make a particular point clearer? If so, another slide needs to be created.
- 4) Do some of the slides seem unnecessary? Hide or delete them.
- 5) Would custom animations help some of the slides? (Advanced technique.)
- 6) Should some of the slides have a different slide transition than others? The transition of those slides should be changed.

Caution



If one or more slides seem unnecessary, hide the slide or slides, and view the slideshow a few more times to make sure they aren't needed. To hide a slide, right-click the slide in the Slides pane and select **Hide Slide** in the pop-up menu. Do not delete a slide until you have done this; otherwise, you may have to create that slide again.

Once you have answered these and your own questions, make the necessary changes. This is done most easily in the Slide Sorter view (see page 10). Use the Slide Show menu to change the order of the slides, choose which ones are shown, automate moving from one slide to the next, and other settings. To change the slide transition, animate slides, add a soundtrack to the presentation, and make other enhancements, use functions in the Sidebar.

Custom Animations

If you wish to add a custom animation to a slide, do it now. Custom animations are found on the Tasks pane. This is an advanced technique and is explained in Chapter 9 (Slide shows).

Slide Transitions

Your first slide show should probably have the same slide transition for all slides. Setting *Advance slide* to **On mouse click** is the default. If you want each slide to be shown for a specific amount of time, click **Automatically after** and enter the number of seconds. Click **Apply to all slides**.

Transition choices are found on the Sidebar. For more information about slide transitions, see Chapter 9 (Slide Shows).

Tip

The Slide transition section has a very useful option: *Automatic preview*. With this option selected, when you make any changes in a slide transition, the new slide is previewed in the Slide Design area, including its transition effect.

Running the Slide Show

To run the slide show, do one of the following:

- Click **Slide Show > Slide Show** on the main menu bar.
- Click the **Slide Show** button on the Presentation toolbar or the Slide Sorter toolbar (Figure 10).
- Press *F5* or *F9*. (*F5* only on a Mac.)

If the slide transition is *Automatically after x seconds*, let the slide show run by itself.

If the slide transition is *On mouse click*, do one of the following to move from one slide to the next.

- Use the arrow keys on the keyboard to go to the next slide or to go back to the previous one.
- Click the mouse button to advance to the next slide.
- Press the *Spacebar* on the keyboard to advance to the next slide.

Right-click anywhere on the screen to open a menu from which you can navigate the slides and set other options.

When you advance past the last slide, the message *Click to exit presentation...* appears. Click the mouse or press any key to exit the presentation.

To exit the slide show at any time, including at the end, press the *Esc* key.